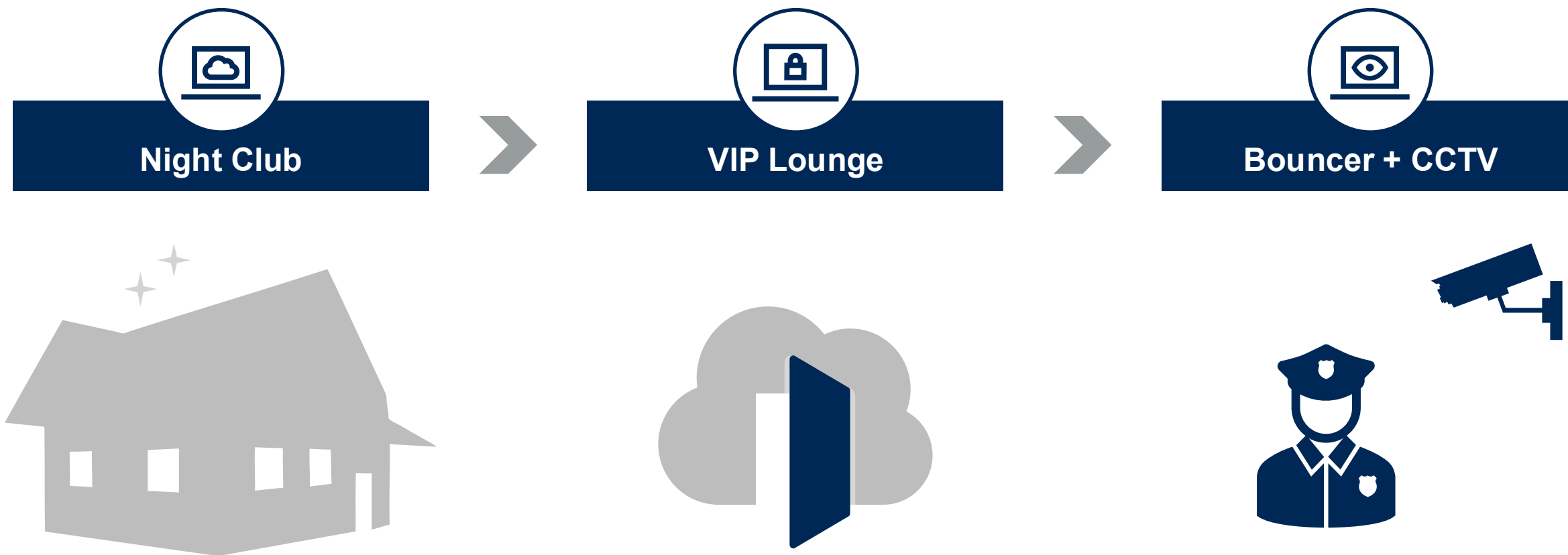


Guidance for Successful Privileged Access Management Deployment

Gautham Mudra

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PAM is the bouncer for the VIP lounge
— only the right people get in, only when needed and always under watch!

Understand the Consequences of Taking **Easy Way Out!**

Backdoor Entrance



Agenda

1. Plan a foundation for PAM

- Define objectives and scope

2. Focus on the first steps

- Inventory & assessment

3. Advance to the next level

- Future roadmap

Objectives: Document Your PAM Objectives

Commonly overlooked objectives

Drivers

Objective	Protect	Comply	Enable
Discover where privilege exists (accounts or entitlements)	✓	✓	
Secure/vault privileged accounts	✓	✓	
Remove unnecessary privileges	✓		
Eliminate static and clear-text workload credentials	✓		
Implement multifactor authentication (MFA) for all administrative access	✓	✓	
Gain observability of privileged access		✓	✓
Implement just-in-time and just-enough privilege	✓		✓
Enable automation for DevOps and cloud use cases	✓		✓

Objectives: Document Your PAM Objectives

Commonly overlooked objectives Perpetual task Hard

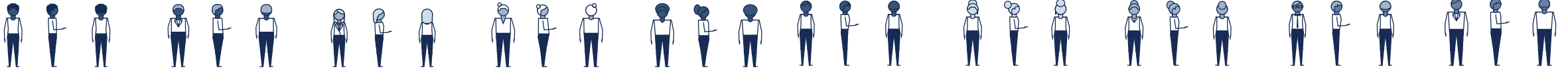
Drivers

Objective	Protect	Comply	Enable
Discover where privilege exists (accounts or entitlements)	● ✓	✓	
Secure/vault privileged accounts	● ✓	✓	
Remove unnecessary privileges	✓		
Eliminate static and clear-text workload credentials	● ▲ ✓		
Implement multifactor authentication (MFA) for all administrative access	✓	✓	
Gain observability of privileged access		✓	✓
Implement just-in-time and just-enough privilege	▲ ✓		✓
Enable automation for DevOps and cloud use cases	✓		✓

Objectives: What's the Goal

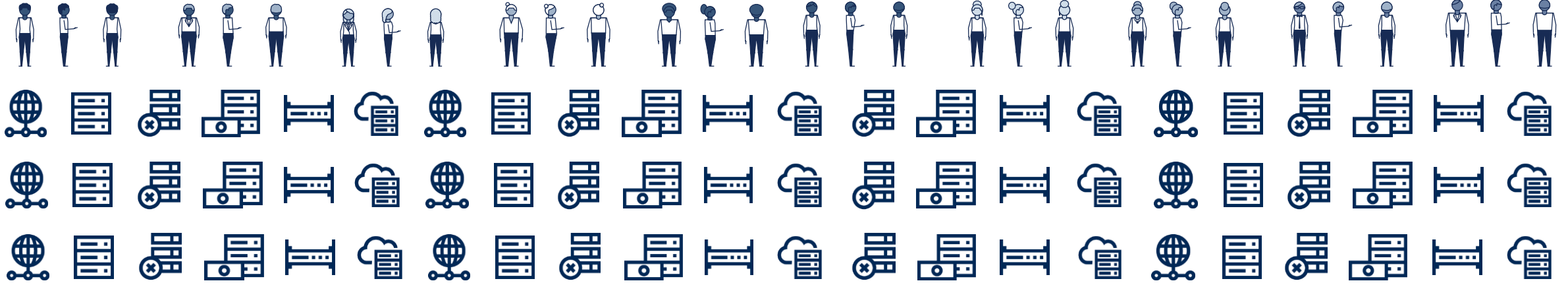


Scope: Identify Critical Actors



**Manage Privileged
Access for People!**

Scope: Identify Critical Actors



Manage Privileged Access for People **and Machines!**



Scope: Define Privileged Access Use Cases

Why do people need privileged access?

- Execute **preapproved changes**.
- Troubleshooting: Fix outages and respond to **incidents**.
- Support ongoing **project** work.
- **Exceptions**: Anything else that doesn't fall into these categories (like **emergency changes/outage recovery**).

PAM and change management go hand in hand!

Scope: Define Privileged Access Use Cases

Key privileged access use cases

 Risk			
 Administration (Human to Machine)	 Connectivity (Machine to Machine)	 Automation (Machine to Machine)	 Cloud (Infrastructure Entitlements)
Servers and Infrastructure  Shared Credential, Insider and Human Error	Database  Hard-Coded Credentials	Scripts  Hard-Coded Credentials	IaaS  Broad Access and Misconfiguration
Endpoints  Local Admin, Malware/Ransomware	Apps/Infrastructure  Hard-Coded Credentials	DevOps Pipelines  Hard-Coded Credentials and Authorization	PaaS  Broad Access and Misconfiguration
Remote Access  IT Supply Chain and Third Parties	Micro/Services  Hard-Coded Credentials and Authorization	RPA and Agentic AI  Shared Human Credentials	SaaS  Broad Access and Misconfiguration

Key Issue Take-Away:

PAM is a complex, **continuous** initiative.

Planning is **fundamental** for success in PAM.

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1. Plan a foundation for PAM

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2. Focus on the first steps

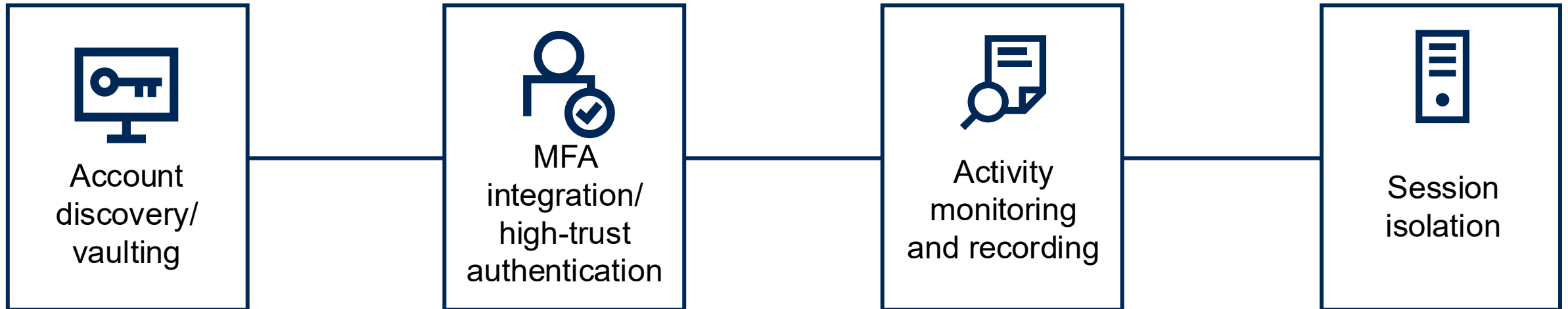
- Inventory & assessment

3. Advance to the next level

- Future roadmap

Typical First Step of PAM Deployment

Mainstream Adoption

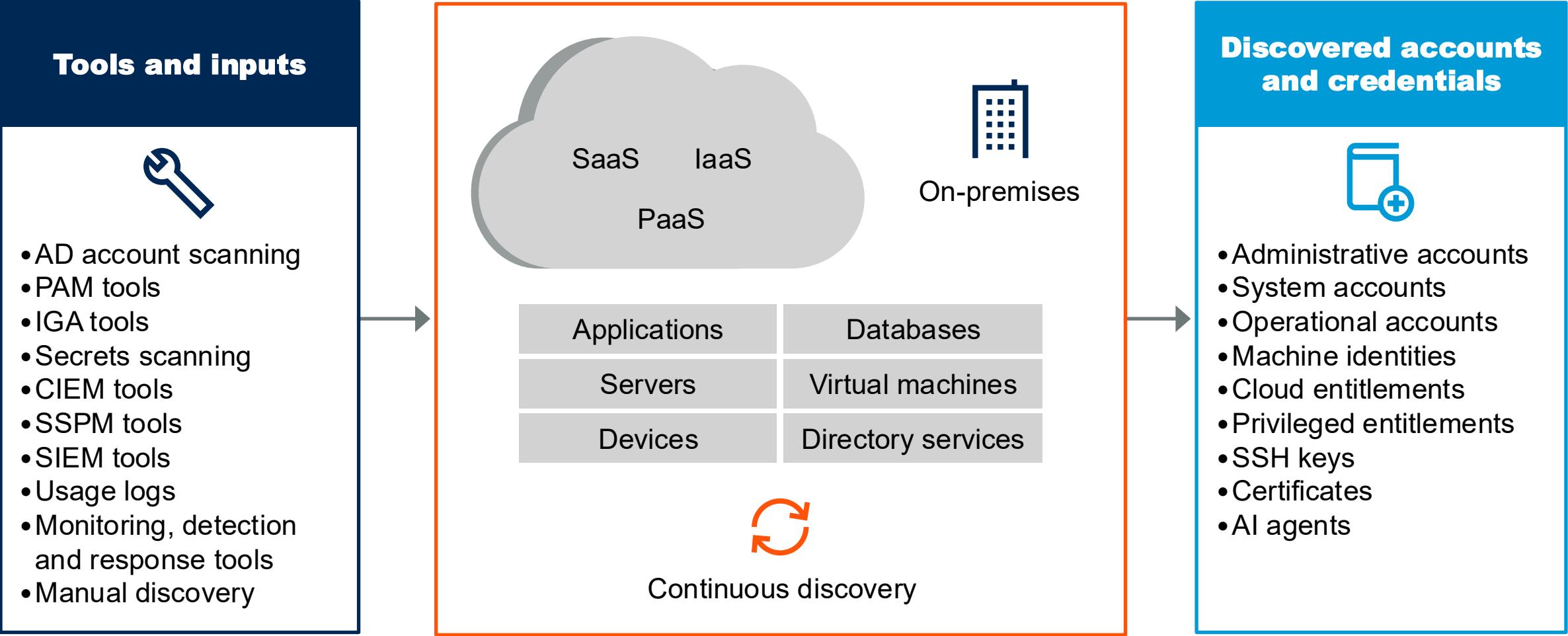


Other options (specialized focus)

- Command elevation/least privilege
- Just-in-time access
- Secrets management
- Remote access

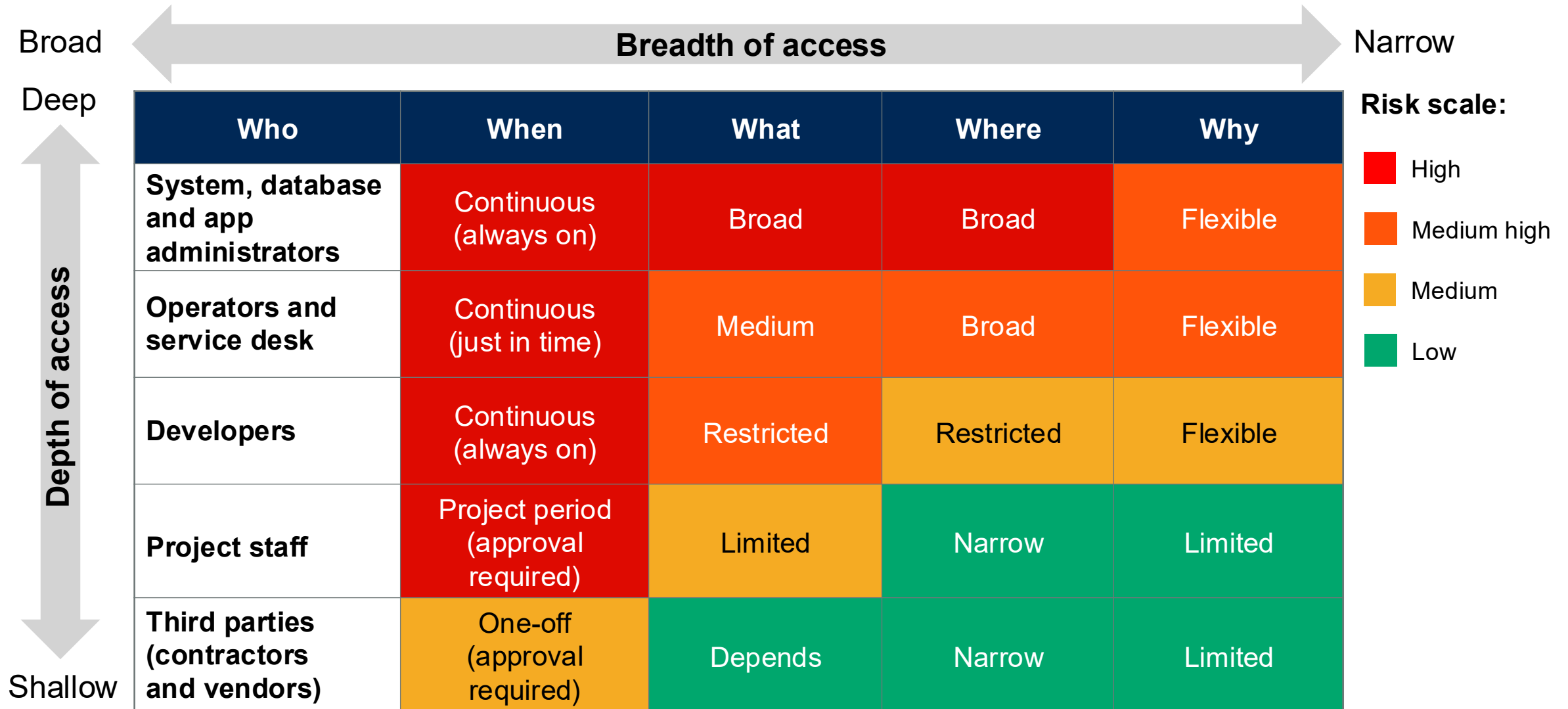
Inventory — Privileged Account Discovery

Continuous discovery in action



CMDB = configuration management database; CASB = cloud access security broker; IGA = identity governance and administration; SIEM = security information and event management; SSPM = SaaS security posture management; SSH = secure shell
Source: Gartner

Assessment: Where to Focus Your Efforts!



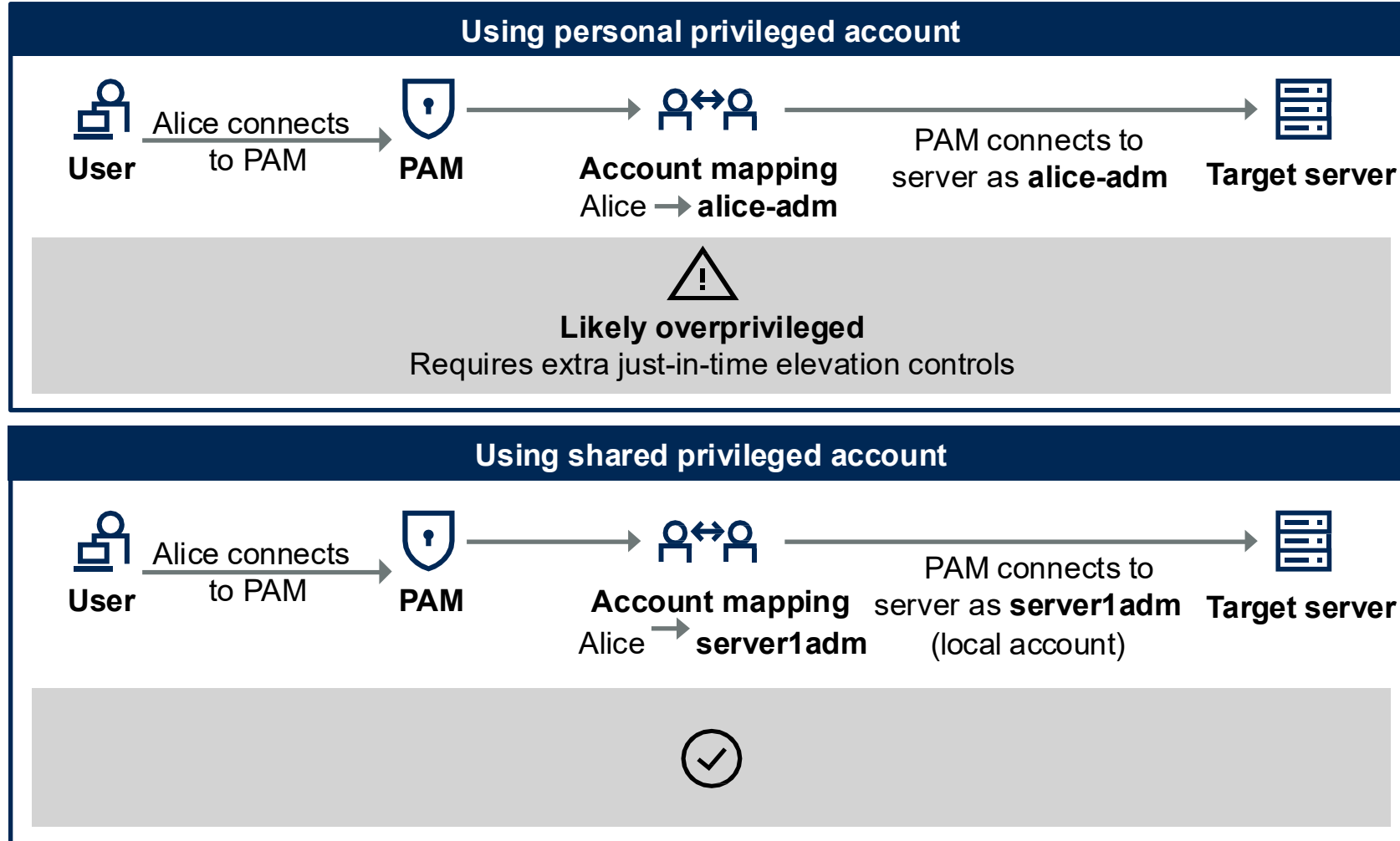
Assessment: Culture Change Ahead

- Shared accounts or personal privileged accounts?
- Disclose credentials or use session management?



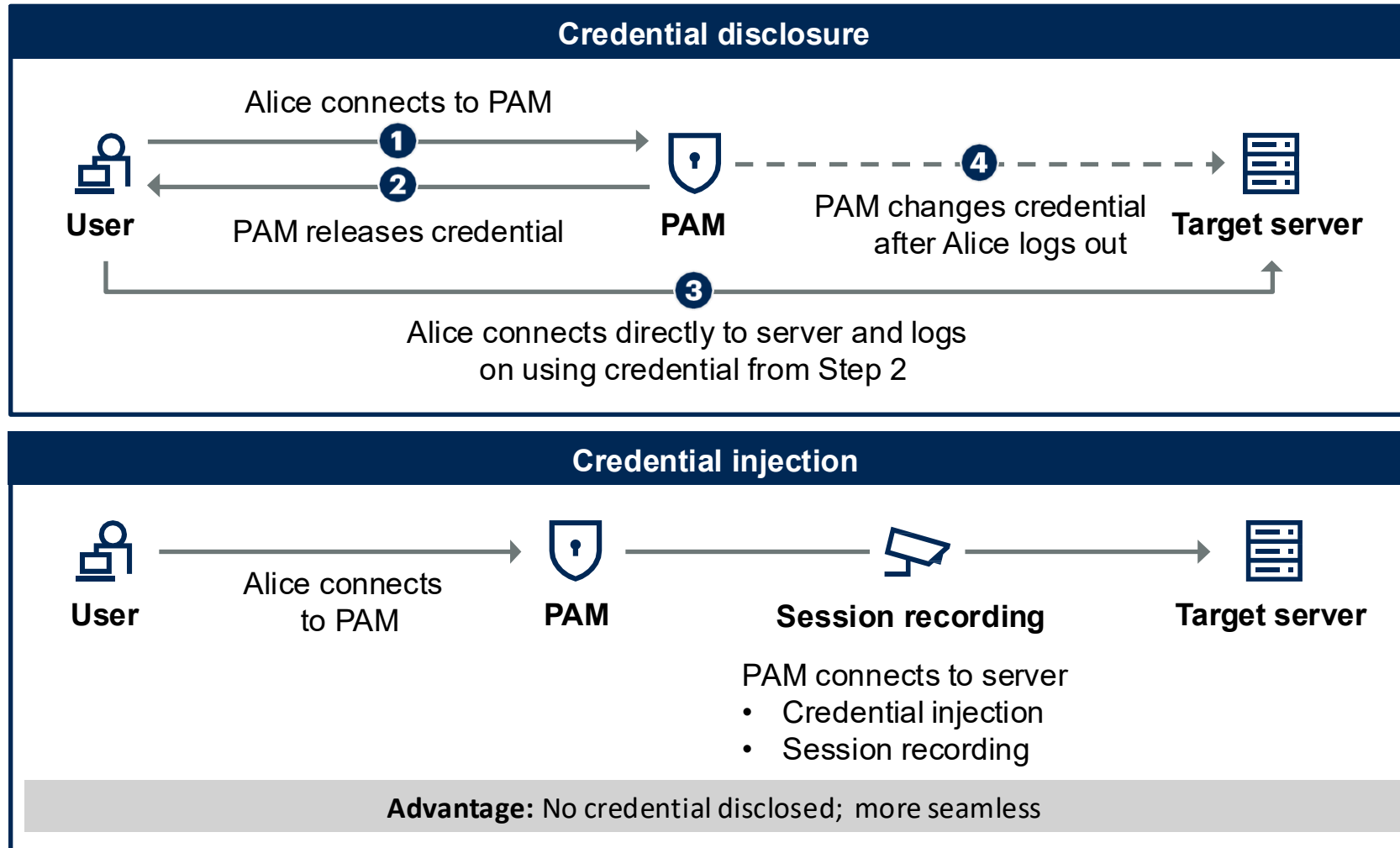
Assessment: Shared vs. Personal Accounts

Example



Assessment: Credential Disclosure vs. Credential Injection

Example



Key Issue Take-Away:

Focus on the basics first:
Discovery, MFA, privileged access model
(**culture change**), session management
and recording.

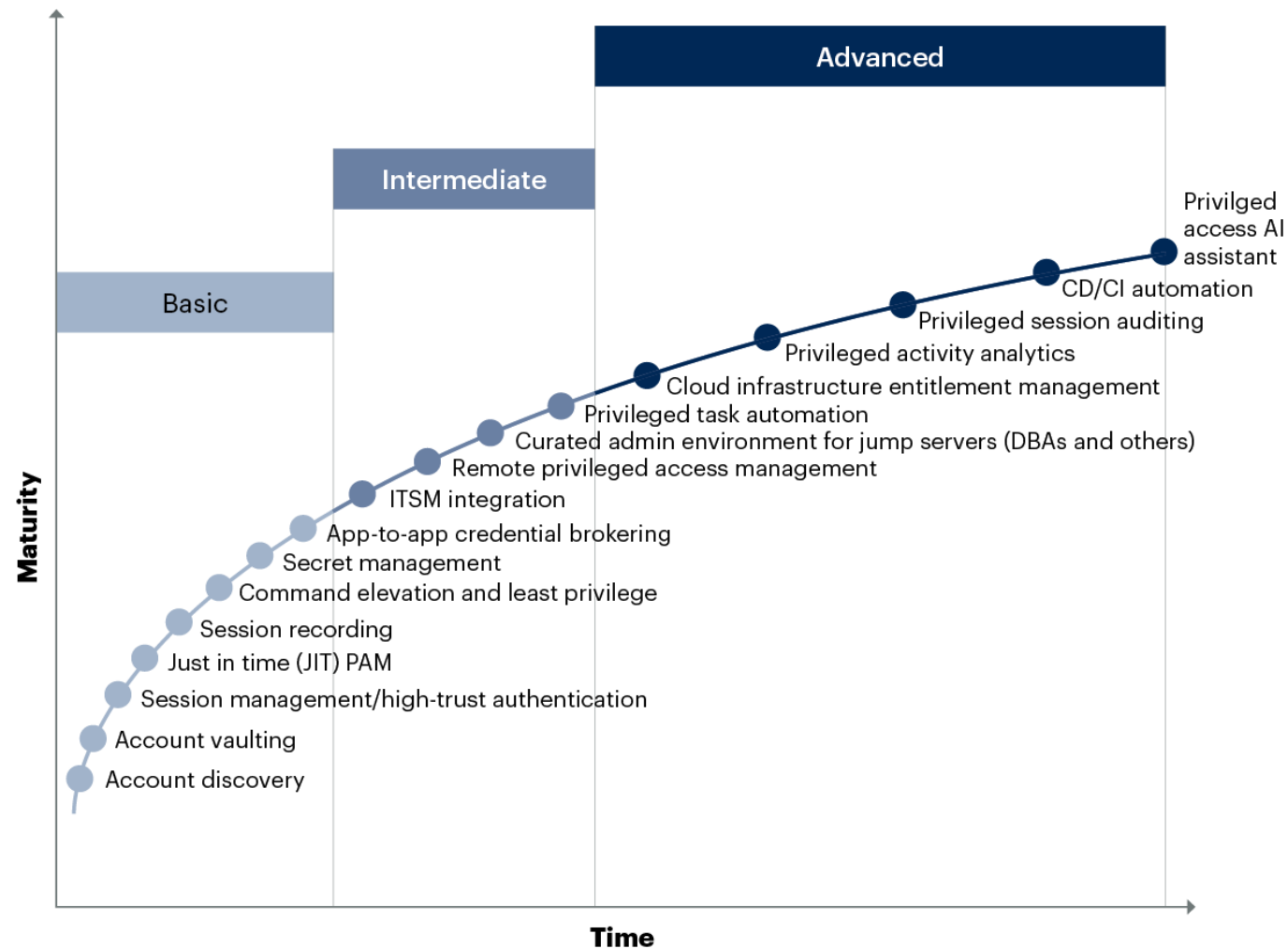
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Roadmap: PAM Capability Deployment (Example)

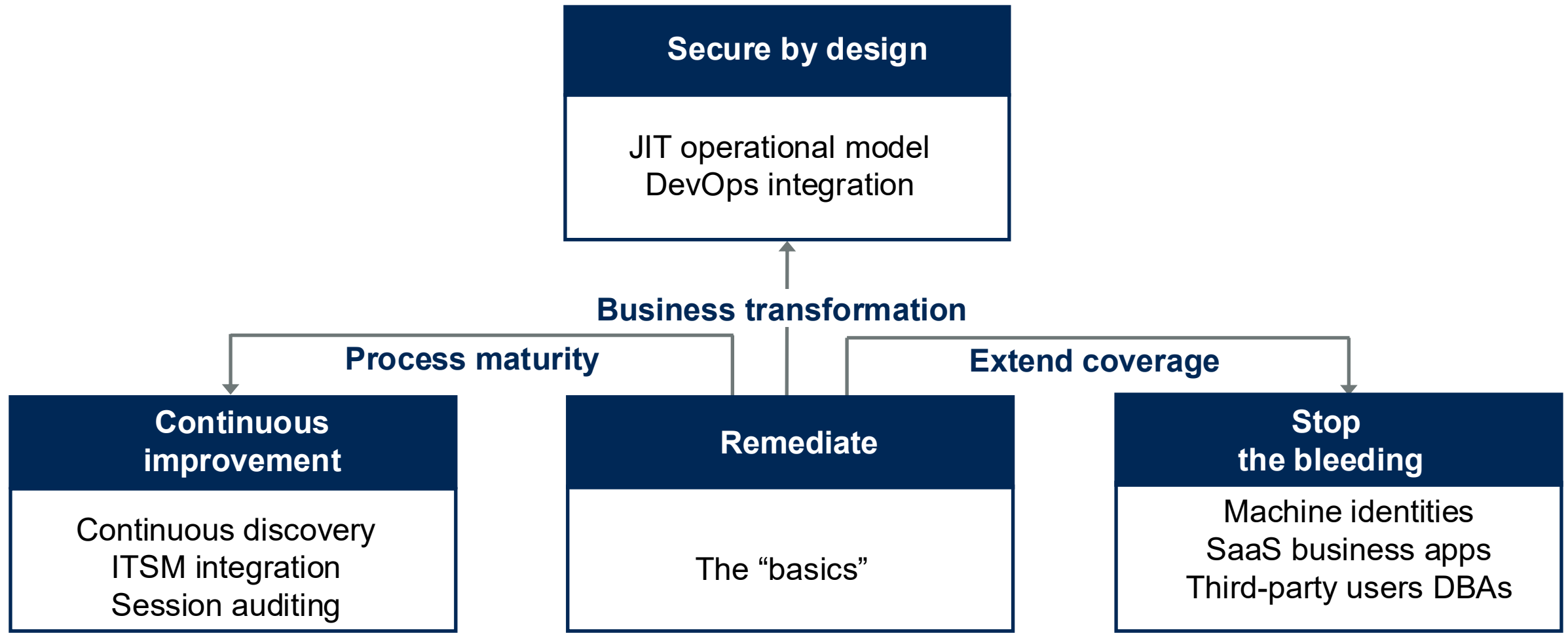
Sample PAM maturity curve

- Steps that must be executed in sequence
- Steps that can be reordered as per organizational priorities



CIEM = cloud infrastructure entitlement management; PAM = privileged access management; PEDM = privileged elevation and delegation management
Source: Gartner

Design: Future Roadmap — Which Turn Will You Take First?

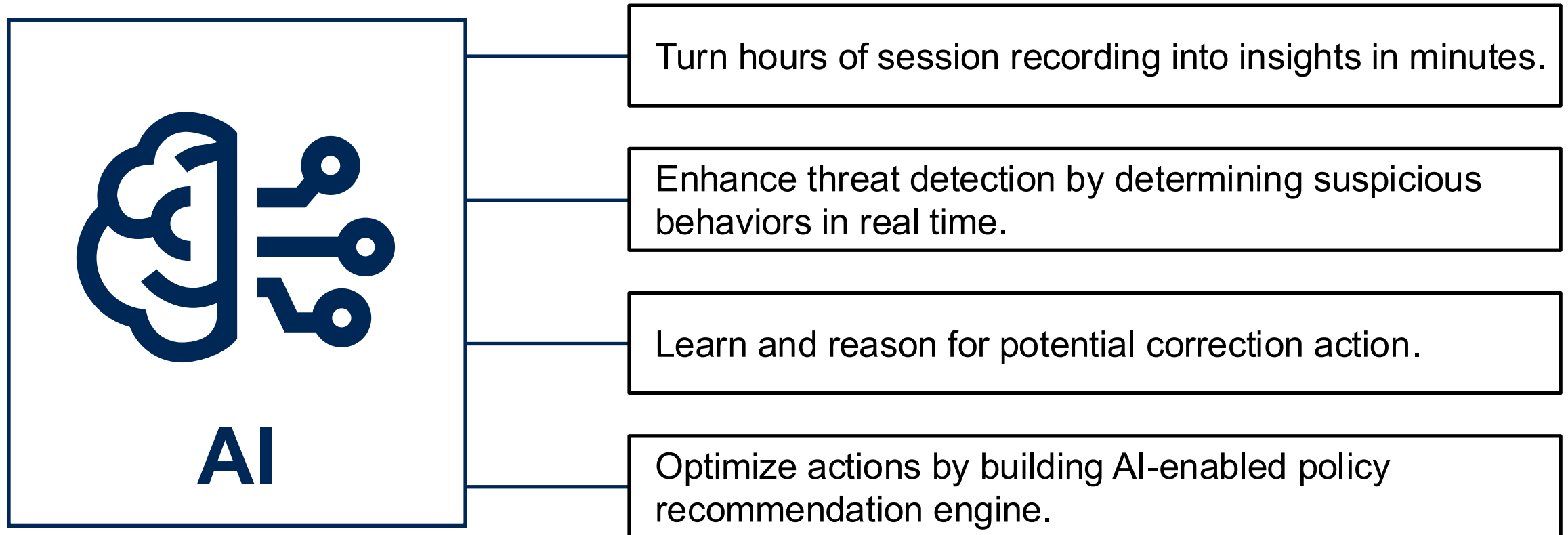


OT = operational technology; ICS = industrial control systems; RPA = robotic process automation

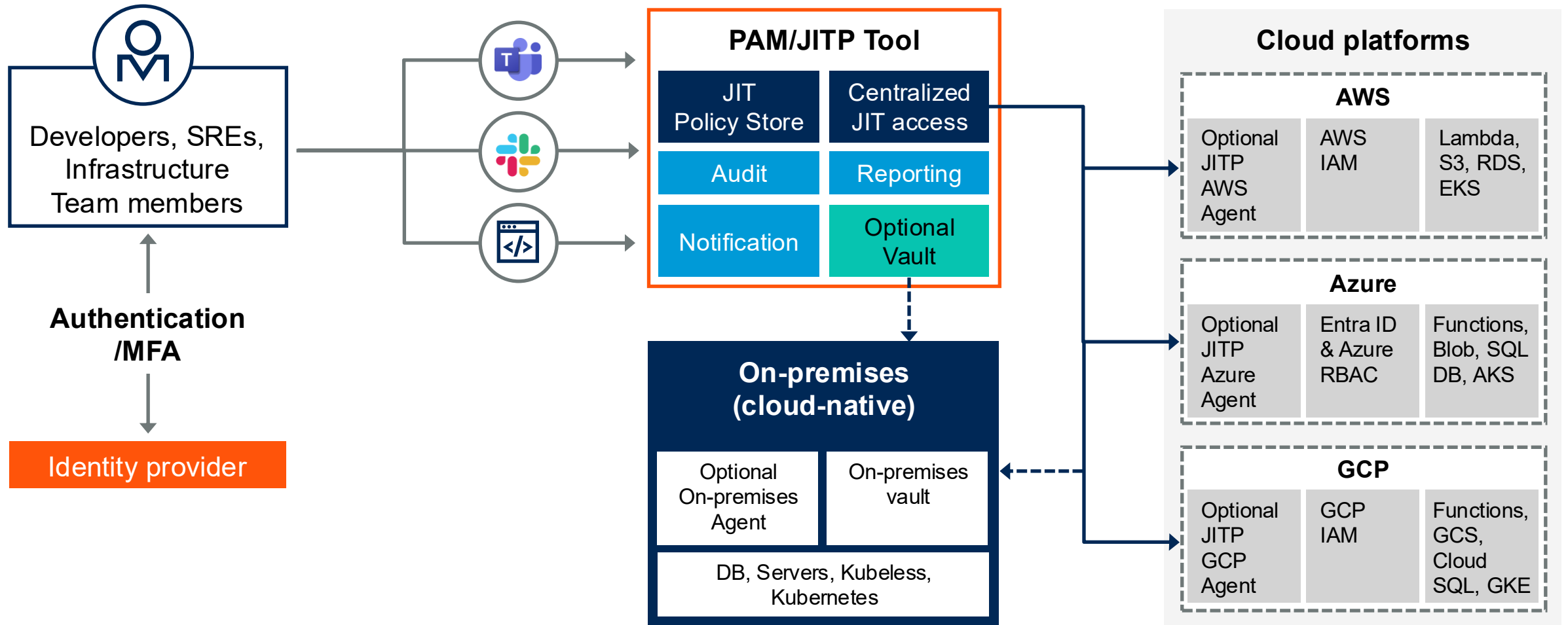
Decision Matrix (Example — Your Mileage Will Vary)

Capability	Business value	Difficulty	Comply	Protect	Enable
Windows PEDM/least privilege	Medium 2	Medium			✓
ITSM integration	Medium 2	Low	✓	✓	
JIT privilege model	High 1	High	✓	✓	
Admin environment for data-sensitive Ops	Medium	Low		✓	
RPA integration	Low 5	Low		✓	✓
CIEM	Medium 3	Medium	✓	✓	
Secrets management	High	Medium		✓	✓
Privileged session auditing	High 1	Medium	✓	✓	

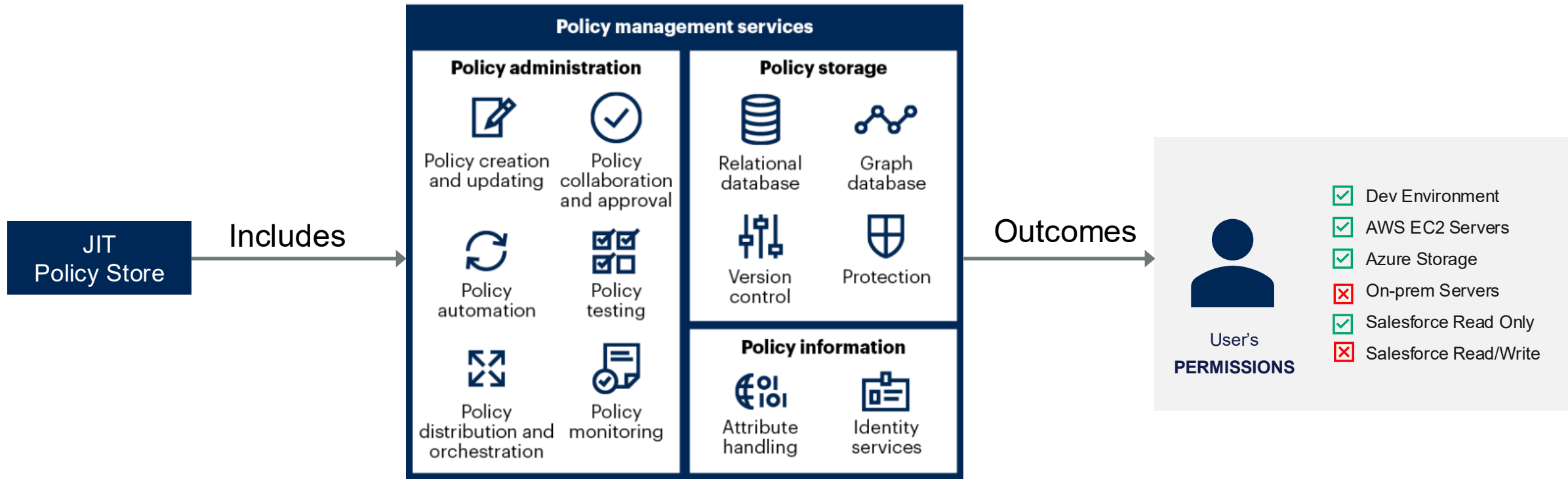
Gen AI-based Session Auditing & Threat Detection



JIT/ZSP Operational Model



JIT/ZSP — Policy Based Authorization



Key Issue Take-Away:

The later phases of a PAM roadmap are more free-form and flexible, once the basics are achieved. Understand that PAM is a long-term initiative.

Recommendations

- ① **Enable other teams:** Support networking or development teams that “manage their own thing.”
- ① **Reusing isn’t always good:** Use separate accounts for humans and machines (RPA/SVC accounts).
- ① **Don’t get bogged down:** Create a separate “run” workstream for integrations.
- ① **Beware of culture shock:** Doing PAM right means changing some old ways for most admins.
- ① **This is like doing the laundry:** You’re never going to be “done.”

Recommended Gartner Research

To learn more about access to Gartner research, expert analyst insight, and peer communities, contact your Gartner representative or click on “Become A Client” on gartner.com to speak with one of our specialists.

- 🔍 [**Magic Quadrant for Privileged Access Management**](#)
Abhyuday Data, Paul Mezzera and Others
- 🔍 [**Buyers’ Guide for Privileged Access Management**](#)
Felix Gaehtgens, Abhyuday Data and Michael Kelley
- 🔍 [**IAM Leaders’ Guide to Privileged Access Management**](#)
Abhyuday Data, Felix Gaehtgens and Michael Kelley
- 🔍 [**Securing Remote Privileged Access Management Through RPAM Tools**](#)
Abhyuday Data, Felix Gaehtgens and Michael Kelley